Pink

Tenderness · care · softness

Pink can recall a peony, an apple tree in bloom, cheeks after a walk or old porcelain. Sometimes it is quiet and gentle, and at other times it has no intention of staying in the corner. People often expect pink to be sweet, good and a little naive. But you can love pink and still know exactly what you want.

This page does not tell you what pink means. **It shows it from several sides**: how it is mixed, how it is painted with, where its reputation comes from, how it is read in different cultures and **what it can awaken in us**.

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How to mix the colour and its shades

One name, several faces. Pink has no stripe of its own in the rainbow. It arises as a lightened red or as a mix of red and white, and so it carries everything from powder pink to fuchsia. **There is no single pink.**

Ready-made tubes have their charm, but **mixing pink teaches you the most**. You will see how white, red and magenta pull against each other, and when a gentle colour turns sugary or, on the contrary, dusty. Start small, on paper, and write down what came from what.

What to prepare



White
The base of all light pink shades.



Red
Depending on its undertone you get a warmer or a cooler pink.



Magenta
A vivid pinkish red for cleaner, brighter mixes.



Yellow or ochre
In small amounts for salmon, peach and earthier tones.



Blue
In tiny doses for a cooler pink close to violet.



Brown
For dusty pink and muted shades.

How can you recognise it without technical names?

The simplest pink is made from white and a small amount of red. **The result will not be the same with every red.** A red with an orange tint can lead you to salmon, while a red close to magenta leads rather to a cooler pink.

When a pigment already has an earthy or orange undertone, **white does not remove it, it only lightens it**. A muted brick can turn into a beautiful skin tone, but not into a sharp pink like a highlighter. For very vivid pinks, start with magenta or a ready-made pink pigment. You will not mix a fluorescent pink just by adding white.

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What the additions do



White

Lightens to powdery and soft. Add it little by little, or start with white.





Magenta

Shifts toward cooler and more saturated. Add it by the tip of the brush, it can take over the whole mix.





Red

Shifts toward warmer, raspberry. Watch out for an orange tint.





Yellow

Shifts toward salmon and peach. Really just the tip of the brush.





Brown

Dusty and muted tones. Too much brown turns it into a dirty beige.





Blue

Shifts toward a cool pink close to violet. Add it in drops.



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Ten pinks to try

A part can be a drop or an equally large dab of paint. **Treat the proportions as a starting point** for experimenting, not as a guarantee of the same shade with every brand.

Light pink



8 parts white and 1 part red. Soft, powdery, clean.

Soft cooler pink



5 parts white and 1 part magenta. Fresh and a little cool.

Saturated pink



3 parts magenta and 1 part white, adding the white gradually. Bold and clean.

Warm salmon



3 parts white and 1 part red, plus a tiny trace of yellow. Warm and soft.

Peach



5 parts white and 1 part red, with a little less yellow still. Summery and light.

Old rose



4 parts pink and a trace of brown, adjust the lightness with white. Quiet and a little nostalgic.

Dusty pink



4 parts pink and a tiny trace of green. Faded, like an old fabric.

Pink with a violet tint



3 parts white, 1 part magenta and a drop of blue. Dreamy and a little cool.

Raspberry



2 parts magenta and 1 part red, a bit of white as needed. Juicy and vivid.

Earthy pink



3 parts white, 1 part red and a trace of ochre or burnt sienna. Calm and natural.

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Rainbow – the chakra system

In the commonly named rainbow, pink has **no stripe of its own**. That does not make it any less real. It simply does not correspond to a single separate region of the spectrum the way green does. In the current rainbow map of chakras, some approaches place it next to green, with the **fourth, heart chakra**, and with the themes of **kindness** and receiving care.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root
Support, safety, presence. Ask yourself. What can I lean on?



Orange · sacral
Experiencing, pleasure, sensuality. Ask yourself. What does me good?



Yellow · solar plexus
Self-worth, will, decision-making. Ask yourself. What do I want to choose for myself?



Green · heart
Closeness, kindness, relationships. Ask yourself. Where can I be open and still stay with myself?



Blue · throat
Voice, expression, communication. Ask yourself. What do I need to say?



Indigo · third eye
Inner vision, intuition, discernment. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown
Transcendence, meaning, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me a wider sense of meaning?



Pink · next to the heart
Care and acceptance. Ask yourself. Am I among those I care for?

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Anahata, the heart chakra

Chakras come from the Indian yoga and tantric tradition. The fourth chakra is called Anahata. It sits in the middle of the chest and, according to descriptions, has twelve petals. In the classical texts it is associated rather with green. Pink is added to it only in some contemporary approaches.

Its theme is **kindness**, closeness and boundaries. It is not only about partnership. It also covers friendship and the ability to **receive care without having to repay it at once**. Green asks how I am in relationship with others. Pink asks whether I can give the same kindness to myself too.

When the chakra is open. You can be kind to others and let others be kind to you. You accept praise and help without having to return it right away.

When the chakra is closed. Modern readings describe withdrawal and protection against further hurt. You brush off a compliment, you refuse help even when you can barely stand, and you treat your own need for closeness as weakness. These are not proof of the state of a chakra, they are situations in which you can get to know yourself. **Protection after being hurt is not a failure.**

In today's view, pink is the colour of this chakra next to green. It serves you as a reminder and a support. It is not a treatment, it is an invitation to notice what does you good.

How to add pink when you are missing gentleness toward yourself

- **Wear it**
  A powder-pink sweater, scarf or shirt. Something soft that gently wraps around you.
- **Put it in your bed**
  Old-rose bedding or a throw. Keep it for every day, not only for guests.
- **Put it in flowers**
  Peonies, roses or a single sprig. A few minutes with them, without your phone.
- **Take it with you**
  A pink hair tie, a small stone (rose quartz, for example) or a small piece of jewellery. And if you like, even a strawberry or a peach in your bag.
- **Paint it**
  Soft areas that flow into each other, without a goal and without judging.
- **Give yourself a small thing**
  A pink pencil, hair tie or mug just for joy.

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When you give so much that you stop being there

Some modern readings describe an overactive heart chakra as excessive giving and a need to rescue people. Care on the outside, exhaustion on the inside. **You do not need more pink.** You need to refill yourself.

- **Add yellow**
  A theme of self-worth and choice. A sunny accessory that brings you back to yourself.
- **Add blue**
  A theme of voicing your needs. Say one thing out loud.
- **Add red**
  A reminder of your own support and boundaries. Lipstick, a scarf or a firm step.
- **Add green**
  Nature and breathing. A walk, a plant, fresh air.

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. Try gently and notice how you actually feel afterwards.

Picture it with an example

All week you have been arranging things, fetching things and reassuring others that they will cope. On Saturday morning you are lying in bed and fancy something gentle. **You do not have to earn it.** Try taking out the pink bedding you were saving for a better occasion, and let an ordinary day come out of it.

Next to pink, other colours can feel gentler. Green refreshes it, brown grounds it and grey calms it. **These are options for a personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a colour combination.

How to use this map

It is a way to sort out the themes you are living through. Are you adding green because nature and people attract you? Or pink because you owe yourself a little kindness? **You choose the meaning.** An added colour does not diagnose your state.

In the classical seven-colour map, pink does not even have an eighth place.

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Free painting – intuition

When we paint freely, with no goal and no effort to make a pretty picture, we often reach for pink when we want **something gentle**, or on the contrary **something that does not fit with gentleness**. But we do not always know why. Sometimes we know exactly why, and sometimes not at all. Both are fine.

What can hide behind a pink stroke

The same pink patch on paper can mean **something completely different each time**, depending on what is going on in us at that moment. That is why it makes no sense to read a picture like a test with one right answer.

Tenderness and care.

Soft, light areas, often around a figure or a heart. A wish to be carefully held.

Playfulness.

Unusual shapes, dots, little waves. A colour that does not take itself seriously.

Infatuation and desire.

More saturated, flowing strokes, raspberry and fuchsia tones. Warmth that does not hide.

Defiance.

A sharp pink next to black or red. A colour that has no intention of apologising.

Sadness beneath sweetness.

Dusty pink, shadows, blurred edges. Something that looks pretty and hurts at the same time.

Memory.

Old porcelain, peonies, a ribbon from childhood. A colour with a specific place.

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Pink in a painting. Can it express what is going on inside?

Yes, it **can** – but it **does not have to**. When painting you sometimes reach for a colour before you can name what you feel. Pink can then give shape to tenderness, anger, emptiness or something you cannot name yet. It can just as well simply be **a pretty colour** you happened to have to hand that day. It gets its meaning only in connection with **your experience**. The colour itself does not know what happened to you. You do, or you will work it out in time.

Art therapy also works with the idea that a picture can express something for which words are hard to find. What matters, though, is not one spot on the paper but **the whole picture** and how it came to be. Your situation, memories, the movement of your hand and your feelings while painting. A predominance of pink alone **is not enough for a verdict** on whether it is tenderness or escape. Perhaps you wanted to allow yourself to be soft. Perhaps the loveliest tube simply fell into your hand.

What if I want to paint it but not wear it?

A painting and a dress may ask two completely different things of you. **A painting can bear your trying it out** without you having to go shopping in it. On canvas you can give pink a huge space without having to accept an idea of how you yourself will look in it.

You reach for pink and a voice says "that will be too sweet". Yet there is only one stroke on the canvas so far. **Try continuing before you condemn the picture** for something it has not even done yet. Pink does not have to depict love. You can paint tenderness, anger, emptiness or something you cannot name yet.

That is completely fine. Sometimes you want to wear it, sometimes just to paint it. A peony on paper and a pink coat in a shop do not rule each other out, but they do not need to go together either.

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When pink takes over the space

First, let your hand work. **You do not have to paint love** or anything cute. Pink can simply be a large unnamed area. The interpretation can wait, and you do not need to choose the right reason before you touch the canvas.

Three things worth noticing

- **QUANTITY**

A detail, or the whole pink field?

A small pink trace can look fragile, but also very decisive. A large area can pleasantly surround you, or start to remind you of an environment you want out of. The amount of pink does not show how much love you have or how much you need care. Notice whether you want it to continue, or whether you need space around it.

- **SATURATION**

Peony or candy floss?

Light powder pink, earthy old rose and sharp fuchsia create completely different impressions. If the light one seems too sweet, you do not have to throw away all of pink. Try a more saturated shade or an earthier companion. Maybe you do not mind the colour, but the form it has had so far.

- **THICKNESS**

Gentleness does not have to mean a careful stroke

You can apply pink in a thick layer, spread it with your palm or let it run. A dense mark can have strength, a translucent one can feel light, uncertain or airy. You do not have to paint tenderly just because you have pink on your brush.

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What to take from the picture

It does not matter what a pink stroke looks like. What matters is what you feel while making it and what is going on in your life at that moment. **Two identical pictures can have a completely different meaning**. One was made in the joy of your own gentleness, the other after a day when you had to put on a nice face. That is why you will not find a dictionary here, but **questions**.

A picture can speak even after time

Perhaps after a while you will notice that pink appeared in a period when you needed to stop forcing yourself to perform. Perhaps it belonged to **infatuation**, **defiance** or the memory of a specific place. In self-reflective work inspired by art therapy, a picture can serve as a trace of your own experience and a way to look back.

Answers often do not come right away

Sometimes you look at what you painted and it tells you nothing. In a week, a month or a year it may suddenly dawn on you: “Aha, this is what I was carrying in myself then.” That is fine. **The picture will wait until you are ready to understand it.**

Neither is wrong and neither is right. **Pink can bear both tenderness and anger**, and often both in one picture.

If very strong or painful feelings appear while painting, do not stay alone with them. Talk about them with someone close or with a therapist. This page does not replace professional care.

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Associations and stories

Our associations

Associations are the connections that form between us and a colour. We are not born with a ready-made list "pink = this", and yet they tend to be surprisingly similar. They are usually made of three layers: **the body**, **culture** and **what we ourselves have lived through**.

From the body

Pink is the colour of **skin, cheeks and lips**, that is, the colour of a living body. A blossoming apple tree, a peony, ripening fruit, dawn. In nature it often appears **briefly and gently**, and that is why it gives us a feeling of something fragile and precious.

From culture

In Europe, pink was long linked with **childhood, girls and sweets**, although in the eighteenth century it was the colour of courts and of men. Today we see it with **two faces**. Sometimes as tenderness and care, sometimes as a bold and defiant colour. We will look at this in more detail in the chapter on cultures.

From what you have lived

A childhood ribbon, grandma's peonies, a first lipstick, a birthday cake, a pink room you did not choose, or a toy someone pushed on you instead of the one you wanted. These memories decide the most. **Two women can look at the same pink** and one feels tenderness, the other pressure.

When you know where your associations come from, it is easier to tell what is really "pink" and what is your story about it. You can ask yourself now. **What does pink connect with first for me, and where do I know it from?**

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Stories

Pink has several stories worth untangling. They show where the colour ends and where we begin.

Pink was not always for little girls

As a colour name, the word "pink" appears in English at the end of the seventeenth century and comes from the flower called the carnation (Dianthus), which is known in English as pinks. In the eighteenth century pink was **the colour of courts**. Madame de Pompadour, the favourite of Louis XV, wore it, and the Sèvres manufactory made a special shade of porcelain for her. Pink was worn regardless of gender.

As late as **1918**, the American trade magazine Earnshaw's Infants' Department wrote that the common rule was pink for boys and blue for girls. Another catalogue advised the opposite at the time. The fixed division settled only in the 1940s, following what shops offered. First Lady **Mamie Eisenhower** helped too, with her pink gown at the 1953 inauguration. Today's link between pink and girls is therefore **not a law of nature**.

Shocking pink

The Italian designer Elsa Schiaparelli mixed magenta with a little white in the early 1930s and created **shocking pink**. This is no longer about inconspicuous tenderness, but a colour that wants to be seen.

The name magenta is interesting in itself. The dye was first called fuchsine, after the fuchsia flower, and in 1860 it was renamed after **the Battle of Magenta** of June 1859. Pink can thus mean an idea, provocation and boldness. Some pinks whisper. Others have already ordered a microphone.

The pink cell that was meant to calm

In the 1970s the American researcher Alexander Schauss described a shade he called **Baker-Miller pink**. In **1979** he persuaded the management of a naval prison in Seattle to paint its cells with it. The report said that after fifteen minutes the tendency toward violence dropped. The story quickly spread to prisons, classrooms and sports changing rooms.

Later controlled experiments, however, **did not confirm** the promise. A 1988 study found no effect on pulse or strength. In 2014, aggression among prisoners fell the same in a pink room as in a grey one. Pink is not a remote control for the nervous system. It may feel pleasant to you, but do not expect it to calm everyone.

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Emotions and feelings

The same pink can evoke **tenderness** in one of us and **aversion** in another, sometimes even both in one day. There is no single fixed effect. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

Tenderness

A wish to **caress** and be caressed. A softness that does not need to be defended.

And why?

Pink is lightened red, that is, **passion softened into gentleness**. Light soft colours often evoke in us a wish to slow down and be careful. For some it is a welcome relief, for others a suspicious sweetness.

Ask yourself

"When did I last touch someone with real tenderness?"

Infatuation

Lightness in the body, **blushing**, a wish to laugh for no reason.

And why?

Pink cheeks are an image of a warmed body. On greeting cards and in adverts, pink is linked with love so often that the connection has **settled in us too**. Real falling in love has no colour, we only sometimes look for one.

And what if I asked you now?

"What makes my heart lighter today?"

Playfulness

A wish to play, **not take yourself seriously** and try something silly.

And why?

Light sweet colours are linked with sweets, toys and celebrations. Playfulness does not have to be childish. It is a way to allow yourself joy without performing.

And try answering now

"What would I do today if nobody were watching?"

Shame

A feeling that you **must not like** what you like. Shame about pink can hit you even in front of the mirror.

And why?

Pink carries a label of sweetness and girlish naivety. Someone who wants to be taken seriously may put it aside. The shame is then not aimed at the colour, but at the idea of what others will think of you.

And now one question for you

"Whose eyes do I imagine when I say it is too much for me?"

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Feelings and experience

Deeper and slower states that settle in us. You often recognise them only after a while.

Permission to receive care

Allowing someone to **look after** you without having to repay it at once.

And why?

Women often give care more easily than they receive it. A soft colour can be a gentle invitation to allow yourself the other as well. **Receiving is a gift**, not a debt.

Ask yourself

"Can I accept something nice without having to deserve it first?"

Guilt about caring for yourself

A feeling that it is **selfish** to take something just for yourself.

And why?

Pink bedding lies in the wardrobe because supposedly there is no reason to take it out just for yourself. It is not about the colour, but about the sentence inside that comfort belongs to guests. **Try taking it out today** and notice what happens.

And what if I asked you now?

"What am I saving for a better occasion?"

Vulnerability

A feeling that you are **exposed** and that the air around you has softened.

And why?

Light soft tones leave a lot of space. Vulnerability is not weakness, it is a willingness to be seen. Pink can accompany it, but it does not have to sort it out for you. **You do not have to open up faster** than is safe for you.

And try answering now

"Who can I show myself to today without a mask?"

Longing for childhood

A scent, a fabric or a peony, and **childhood is suddenly close**.

And why?

Colours attach to specific places. Pink can bring back grandma's garden, or a room where you did not feel at home. Longing or relief shows everything you carry with the colour.

And now one question for you

"What would I give my younger self today?"

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My pink is not the same as your pink

The colour itself **experiences nothing**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the **experience** sticks to it. The colour then becomes a **shortcut**. That is why **your own reaction** is the most important.

- **Peony**
  For one woman summer and grandma's garden, for another a funeral bouquet.
- **Pink jumper**
  For one comfort and tenderness, for another the role of the good girl.
- **Powder lipstick**
  For one joy in herself, for another a mask meant to please.
- **Pink room**
  For one safety, for another a room she did not choose.
- **Pink ribbon**
  For one a celebration, for another a memory of someone close.

Why does it attract me right now?

Perhaps you had to be the strong one for a long time. Arranging things, enduring, not troubling anyone with your own needs. Then suddenly a pink jumper or a peony stops you. Not necessarily because you have turned into a romantic. **Perhaps you are drawn to something that feels softer** than the world so far. Equally, a sharp pink can attract you precisely because it cannot be overlooked. You do not want to soften, you want to finally buy the jacket that you like.

Why can't I stand it?

You may see in it a nursery, cheap decoration or the idea of a woman who is mainly supposed to look nice and not argue much. Then perhaps you are not rejecting tenderness. **You are rejecting the meaning someone packed together with pink.** Try imagining side by side a pink work shirt, an old rose in the garden and a plastic crown. The same colour family, quite different company.

When to keep it and when to take some away

Keep it when you feel good beside it, like looking at it and do not have to talk yourself into a pleasant impression. Take away when the whole seems too sweet, sharp or foreign. First try one change. A different shade, fewer decorations, the company of wood. **You do not have to feel tenderness on command.** It is legitimate to admit that today it does not suit you.

Ask yourself

“Which sentence about pink is loudest in me? Whose is it, actually?”

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Pink in cultures and traditions

Pink is a colour people long thought of as "obvious". Sweet, girlish, good. Behind its reputation, though, are **more stories about fashion, commerce and courage than about the colour itself**. Let us visit a few places and read them carefully.

This chapter therefore shows **two levels**. First, how pink is read in different **cultures**, and then how **traditional systems** look at it, using it as an image, not as instructions. What is verified history and what is later interpretation, I say in each part.

Pink in different cultures

Japan

In Japan pink is the colour of spring. The shade of cherry blossom is called **sakura-iro** and the traditional shade of peach blossom **momo-iro**. In spring people gather for hanami, sitting under the blossoming trees.

From a beauty that lasts only a few days. Pink here is not sweetness, but **a reminder that everything passes**.

A colour can become a celebration of a moment that cannot be stored away. It does not have to last to be worth something.

India

Jaipur is called the Pink City because in **1876** the whole of it was painted pink for a visit of the Prince of Wales. It has carried the name ever since. In Uttar Pradesh the women's group Gulabi Gang, meaning the pink gang, was formed in **2006**. Its members wear pink saris and protect women from violence.

From hospitality and from a need to be seen. The pink sari is a uniform that, according to the founder Sampat Pal, **commands respect** and gives a sense of community.

A colour can be a celebration as well as protection. Pink here is not weakness, but **a sign that this woman will not stay silent**.

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USA

In **1953**, at President Eisenhower's inauguration, his wife Mamie wore a pink gown, and pink became more firmly tied to femininity in the United States. A few decades later, in **1991**, the pink ribbon became a symbol of breast cancer awareness.

From fashion, advertising and public campaigns that gradually taught the colour to carry a message.

A colour can bring people together and unite them, but it can also **become overloaded with meaning**. The pink ribbon is so well known today that it easily overshadows how many women wear it from their own experience.

Germany and twentieth-century Europe

In the 1930s and 1940s, some prisoners in Nazi concentration camps, accused of homosexuality, had to wear a **pink triangle** on their clothing. It later became a symbol of the gay rights movement.

From a forced marking of people that turned into a sign of dignity and memory.

A colour can carry a history that raises no smile. **The same pink** can be playfulness and a memorial. It depends on the place where you meet it.

Pink in traditional systems

Every tradition looks at pink **a little differently**, but all take it seriously. It is an old symbolic language and an inspiration, not a healing manual.

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Traditional Chinese medicine

In the classical system of five elements the basic colours are green or blue-green, red, yellow, white and black. **Pink has no organ circuit of its own in it.** That is why we will not make a special healing colour out of it for the heart, lungs or hormones.

Red is linked in this system with fire and the heart. **We can take pink as a gentler form of red**, but that is already our colour metaphor, not a separate teaching of traditional Chinese medicine.

How it relates to pink. You can imagine fire as the joy of meeting, liveliness and the possibility of being with others. It does not always mean flames up to the ceiling. Pink is a fire that **does not have to burn at full strength**.

And what if I asked you now?

"What really warms me, and what only looks pretty?"

Warmth you do not have to keep handing out

Sometimes you do not need another celebration. You need to be with someone in front of whom you do not have to keep up a good mood at any cost. **A surrounding that reminds you of acceptance can be the gain**, not another demand.

Pleasant softness, or forced sweetness

Imagine two rooms. In one there is a muted pink bedspread, wood and room to sit. In the other pink walls, glossy decorations and a sign saying "Smile". Perhaps in the first your shoulders relax, and in the second you feel like leaving. These are not two diagnoses. Pink should **accompany you**, not keep you busy playing another role.

Traditional Chinese medicine uses the elements as an image. It is not a diagnosis and does not replace a doctor.

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Ayurveda

Ayurveda is an old Indian teaching about health. It describes a person by three types of "energy", the so-called doshas. Vata (air, restlessness), pitta (fire, intensity) and kapha (earth and water, heaviness). Colours are not assigned to the doshas uniformly in the classical texts, so here you read **modern interpretations**, not an old table.

How it relates to pink. Soft, light pink is often seen in contemporary approaches as gentle and calming. The exact assignments differ, though. For your own practice it is more useful to notice the difference between **soft pink and sharp fuchsia** than to call every shade calming.

Pitta

This describes a woman who is purposeful, quick and thorough, who flares up easily. A muted powder pink can feel cooling and soft. A sharp fuchsia may pour oil on the fire.

- **Powder and peach**
  Soft and calming, as an accent.
- **Beware of the sharp**
  A glowing glossy pink can be one more stimulus.

Vata

This describes a woman who is imaginative and quick, but restless and often cold. Warmer old rose and salmon can add warmth. **It is best to notice how you really feel in it.**

- **Old rose**
  Warm and earthy, without chill.
- **Evening and sleep**
  Gentle shades and warm light.

Kapha

This describes a woman who is calm, steady and patient, but who easily grows heavy. Too powdery and sweet may deepen the heaviness. The tradition advises **lively and warm colours**.

- **Raspberry and coral**
  Richer and livelier, as an accent.
- **Add movement**
  Orange or yellow as a counterweight. A scarf, a tablecloth.

What is useful for us is that Ayurveda works with qualities. Lightness and heaviness, warmth and cold, softness and sharpness. After a day full of demands you may enjoy a muted fabric and a simple surrounding. That is why I **am not writing a colour prescription** for a specific dosha.

An online test will not reliably determine your dosha. If you are more interested, consult a qualified Ayurvedic practitioner. It is not treatment.

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A Jungian view

Carl Gustav Jung, the Swiss psychiatrist, understood colours as symbols that have two layers. A personal one (what we have experienced with the colour) and one shared by all people (images that repeat across ages and cultures).

Jung did not describe pink as a colour of its own. What I write next is my own reflection in the spirit of his thinking, not his statement.

How it relates to pink. In the Jungian picture red is often the colour of feeling and life, white of purity and light. Pink, made of both, could be the colour of **feeling that is not afraid to be soft**. When you think about it, ask where you allow yourself to be gentle and where you do not.

What you can take from it. Jung did not want colours turned into a dictionary. **We always ask what it means for you.** The same pink can be joy for one woman and pressure for another. Jung's ideas about colours are a symbolic frame, not verified science.

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Feng shui

Feng shui is the Chinese art of arranging space so that it is good to live in. In some Western schools the southwest of the house map (bagua) is linked with relationships and partnership, and pink, red and white are used for it. Schools differ on this, so take it as one possibility.

Pink is like a peony

A few petals give a room softness, a full peony turns it into a sweet shop. Closeness is not the number of pink cushions.

Simple tips

- **Start with one piece**
  For example a cushion or a flower in a place where you will see it every day.
- **For every day**
  Powder, old rose and peach. Leave rich fuchsia for small accents.
- **Natural materials**
  Combine it with wood, linen and wool and with light colours.
- **Bedroom**
  Muted old rose in bedding or on part of a wall. Make sure it is not glossy and sugary.
- **Try fabric first**
  Before you repaint a room, try a throw or a larger sample and look at it in the morning and in the evening.
- **Watch the proportion**
  When there are too many pink things, taking one away helps more than adding another.

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What people say and what holds true

MYTH Pink is named after the rose.

TRUTH In Czech that fits, but the English "pink" is, according to dictionaries, derived from the name of a flower, the carnation. The colour took its name from the blossom, not from the rose.

MYTH Pink in the bedroom will bring love.

TRUTH Feng shui links the southwest with partnership and some consultants recommend pink there. Recommendations differ and a colour guarantees nothing. How you sleep in the bedroom will help more.

MYTH The sweeter the pink, the more tenderness.

TRUTH A very sweet or loud pink can tire you. Powder, peach or dusty pink have a softer and more grown-up look.

What pink goes well with

- **Green**
  Flower and leaves. Muted shades look more natural.
- **Indigo and dark blue**
  Greater depth and contrast.
- **Ochre, terracotta and brown**
  A more earthy whole.
- **Cream, linen and wood**
  A gentler, less over-sweet impression.
- **Red**
  A striking related pair, give one of the colours more space.
- **Black and gold**
  A sharper graphic look. Gold in excess recalls a shop window more than a home.

Elements

- **Fire**
  Pink is its gentle form. Make sure it does not outweigh the rest.
- **Wood**
  Green and wood ground it.
- **Earth**
  Clay and linen soften the sweet impression.
- **Water**
  Blue and dark tones cool and deepen it.

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Feng shui room by room

Living room

What works. An old-rose armchair or a picture can soften a grey or navy room. A green plant and natural materials bring the whole closer to a garden than a sweet shop.

What to watch for. A sharp pink sofa that disturbs in the evening. First try a muted throw, you do not have to order new furniture at once.

A simple tip. Start with one thing. It is easier to tell whether you missed a warmer colour, or whether the light needed changing and things needed taking away.

Kitchen and dining room

What works. Pink on ceramics, a tea towel or part of the furniture. Next to wood and a simple base it feels lived-in.

What to watch for. A large sweet surface without wood can feel like a confectioner's. A kitchen is mainly meant to be used.

A simple tip. Try a pink mug or tablecloth and leave the rest light.

Bedroom

What works. Muted pink, old rose or a soft pink-beige tone in bedding, a throw or on part of a wall. A softer and more personal impression, especially when your bedroom feels cold.

What to watch for. Glossy pink surfaces and too many decorations. If you live with a partner, look for a form pleasant to you both. A bedroom is not proof of who won the colour referendum.

A simple tip. Combine pink with linen, cream and wood. Replace part of the textiles with a calmer base.

Children's room

What works. If a child loves pink, they can have it. But they do not have to get a pink floor, furniture, ceiling and future.

What to watch for. The whole set in one shade. Strong shades are easier to change in pictures and textiles than in furniture.

A simple tip. Leave room for other colours and for a change of taste. A room that can grow with the child.

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Study and studio

What works. Muted pink on part of a wall, in a picture or on upholstery can be personal and unobtrusive. Pleasant does not mean unprofessional.

What to watch for. A striking fuchsia that keeps drawing the eye. Put it outside the main line of sight.

A simple tip. You do not have to remove pink because of an idea that serious work may only happen between grey and beige.

Hallway and bathroom

What works. In a bathroom you can easily try pink on towels. In a hallway a flower, a picture or a rug is enough as a first greeting.

What to watch for. For make-up and judging your skin keep ordinary good lighting, not a pink light that tints everything. Otherwise you will see your make-up only outdoors.

A simple tip. Try one soft piece and look at it both in the morning and in the evening.

And try answering now

“Why do I want pink at home? What should it bring me, warmth, playfulness, or a feeling of being welcome?”

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Colour frequency and phototherapy

With pink people often talk about "frequency" and "heart energy". It sounds as if it had its own number that could be read off. A pink fabric **reflects** light, a pink lamp **emits** light. Let us say what of this is **atmosphere** and what is already **treatment**.

And it is just here that it is good to leave aside **miraculous promises**. Pink light **is not a key to the heart chakra** nor a cure for hormones and mood.

What frequency does pink have?

Pink does not belong to one single frequency of light. **A pink impression arises from a combination of light components**, not from a separate pink band in the spectrum. That is why it makes no sense to assign every pink jumper one "photon number" and derive from it an effect on emotions.

That pink feels pleasant to you does not lose its value, though. Just look for the explanation in the whole experience, not in one magic number. It can **attract** you, calm you or, on the contrary, irritate you. That is an exact description of an experience and needs no physics.

What you can try at home

Try a pink lamp as a gentle **indirect light** during music, rest or your own ritual. A coloured atmosphere does not have to replace the main lighting of the whole room. **What it can bring you.** A softer mood than an ordinary lamp gives. If you squint, the light dazzles you or you see badly in it, change it.

Where light is really studied

Cosmetic masks

A device can combine several kinds of light and look pink or purple. Appearance alone, though, does not tell you what it uses or what it is meant for. In dermatology, for example, **red and near-infrared light** is used for some skin targets and types of hair thinning. The effect is judged by the specific light, dose and purpose of the device, not by the name "pink mode".

Heart symbolism

For work with heart symbolism you can stay with a pleasant fabric, a picture or an imagined light. **You do not need a therapeutic device for your own moment of stillness.** If you want to use light therapy for a health or skin problem, discuss its suitability with a doctor or the relevant specialist.

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Astrotype and colours

Are you Libra, Sagittarius or Pisces? The astrotype is a much broader topic than just the sun sign. If you really want to go into **depth**, knowing only your date of birth is not enough. The exact place and time of birth are also important, because only from them are the ascendant, the position of the Moon, planets and other parts of the horoscope calculated. Here, though, we stay only at the edge of what relates to colours.

In astrological tradition pink is most often linked with Venus. With love, beauty and pleasure. In other sources you will also find it with the Moon and with Mars as a muted red. Traditional sources differ here, so take it as inspiration. Depending on how the planet of your sign relates to pink, it may feel close to you, or distant. Find your sign (the dates are approximate and change by year) and read what pink may say to you.

The ascendant is the sign that was rising on the eastern horizon at the moment of your birth. According to astrological tradition it shows how you come across outwardly and how you enter the world, while the Sun sign describes more who you are inside. For each sign you will therefore find not only its character but also a short note on how the colour fits when it is your ascendant.

Aries (21 March – 19 April)

Your pink

fuchsia · pink · salmon

A pink that **lets you be both firm and soft** at once.

Aries is linked with Mars, fire and the start of spring. Pink is for it like a red that has learned to smile. A rich fuchsia may suit you as **courage with humour**, so that you do not have to choose between strength and gentleness.

What Aries is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality cardinal · ruler Mars

Aries opens the zodiac and you can tell that it is first. It is a **pioneer** who gets into things before thinking them through perfectly. It is direct, impatient and likes to compete. It gets angry quickly but forgives quickly too.

Its strength is the **courage** to begin. Weaker is perseverance in long, slow matters. It does best where something is happening and where it can act at once.

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What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you want to show that strength and tenderness are not opposites. It fits where you want to be quick, but not harsh.

With Aries the strength is often in the first step. A sharper pink can add **playfulness** and take away some pointless fighting.

Shadow defiance that is afraid of going soft

In the shadow, Aries rejects pink precisely because it might seem soft in it. Gentleness becomes something to be ashamed of.

Aries likes to win and pink may mean defeat. Defiance then becomes armour in which there is no room left for touch.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **try pink as an accent** and notice that gentleness weakens no one.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mars red or black as a frame.

red · black · brown

Red or black give pink a backbone and pink gives them playfulness.

Aries as ascendant

When Aries is your ascendant, you come across as direct, lively and decisive. People may see you as someone who gets straight to the point, and the first impression tends to be brisk.

Pink gives you an unexpected softness. Richer shades suit you more than powder ones.

In everyday life

Take something pink in your hand and try to do with it something you would otherwise put off.

When you feel like pushing through, put a pink thing on the desk. ***It will remind you that decisiveness can also be done with a smile.***

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Taurus (20 April – 20 May)

Your pink

powder pink · old rose · peach

Pink as **velvet, satin and the scent of peonies**.

Taurus is an earth sign linked with Venus, the senses and stability. Pink suits it as a **material**, not as an idea. In velvet, satin or the scent of a peony it may feel luxurious and calm to you.

What Taurus is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality fixed · ruler Venus

Taurus is an earthy, **patient** and sensual sign. It likes good food, pleasant materials, nature and security. It gets going slowly, but once it decides on something, it persists.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to enjoy the present moment. The weaker side tends to be stubbornness and finding it hard to let go of what is familiar.

What it can support in you

Pink can support the joy of touch, scent and beautiful things. It fits where you want comfort with a touch of ceremony.

With Taurus it is often not only about colour but about material. Old rose on wool or velvet feels completely different from a glossy synthetic.

Shadow sweet comfort that lulls you

In the shadow, Taurus surrounds itself with pleasant things so that it does not have to change anything. Comfort becomes a place that is hard to leave.

Taurus likes certainty and pink may be for it the colour of a reward that keeps repeating. Then nothing happens, because it is too good here.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **choose one thing that pleases you** and let the rest breathe.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add green or wood and air.

green · wood · cream

Nature gives pink the ground under its feet and prevents over-sweetness.

Taurus as ascendant

When Taurus is your ascendant, you come across as calm, stable and pleasant. You build trust slowly and people often feel firm ground in you.

Pink gives your calm look some softness. Old rose suits more than a sharp one.

In everyday life

Take in your hand something pink that you like and notice how it feels under your fingers.

A peony in a vase or a pink throw. ***Treat yourself to them without apology.***

Gemini (21 May – 20 June)

Your pink

salmon · powder pink · fuchsia

A pink that **adds playfulness to your words**.

Gemini is an air sign linked with Mercury, curiosity and speech. Pink suits it as a light and cheerful colour that does not have to be serious. **A crayon among pencils**, with which you can write, draw and joke.

What Gemini is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Gemini is **curious**, talkative and adaptable. It learns quickly, likes to tell stories and enjoys it when a lot is going on around it. It can see several sides of one thing.

Its strength is **lightness** and wit. The weaker side tends to be scatteredness and a tendency to start more things than can be finished.

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What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you look for a light tone and do not have to explain everything. It fits a diary, a sketchbook and a poster.

With Gemini the strength is often in ideas and words. A lighter pink can add **a touch of tenderness**.

Shadow pretended lightness

In the shadow, Gemini uses playfulness as a screen. Pink is then sweet and funny, and nobody finds out what is really going on underneath.

Gemini likes to talk and pink can give it a role in which it only laughs. In the long run that tires, because its own sensitivity stays without words.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **write one sentence that you would not say aloud** and let it stand even without an audience.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mercury yellow or light blue.

yellow · sky blue · white

Yellow and blue add clarity of thought and airiness.

Gemini as ascendant

When Gemini is your ascendant, you come across as lively, friendly and chatty. People may see you as curious and youthful, even if inside you are perhaps calmer.

Pink gives you a softness that smooths a quick first impression. Apricot and salmon are the lightest.

In everyday life

Take a pink notebook and write down in it three things that amused you today.

*When it seems to you that you are only joking, give yourself **a moment of silence with a pink thing**. You do not have to joke about everything.*

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Cancer (21 June – 22 July)

Your pink

old rose · powder pink · peach

Pink as **quiet care** you can lean on.

Cancer is a water sign linked with the Moon, home and feeling. Pink may seem to it like a safe blanket. In muted shades you may like **old porcelain, a woollen blanket and warm light**.

What Cancer is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality cardinal · ruler Moon

Cancer is **caring**, sensitive and strongly connected to home and family. It has a good memory for feelings and relationships. It enters the world cautiously, much like a crab with its shell.

Its strength is **empathy** and the ability to create safety. The weaker side tends to be changeable moods and a tendency to withdraw when it feels hurt.

What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you want to make a home more pleasant or give someone something soft.

With Cancer the strength is often in empathy. Old rose can add **permission for care for yourself too**.

Shadow watching that everybody is content

In the shadow, Cancer cares so carefully that it stops noticing it needs something too. Pink becomes the carer's uniform.

Cancers fear that if they stopped they would lose love. So they watch the moods of others and overlook themselves. The colour then carries exhaustion as tenderness.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **take a pink thing just for yourself** and not justify it to yourself.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add the Moon's white and silver.

white · silver · anthracite

White and silver give pink distance so that care does not vanish into giving away.

Cancer as ascendant

When Cancer is your ascendant, you come across as gentle and careful. At first you keep your distance, but then warmth unfolds and people see in you someone who will look after them.

Pink gives you a sense of softness and carefulness. Muted shades suit.

In everyday life

In the evening take something pink in your hand and sit for a while without tasks.

*When you are tired of giving, take **a pink towel or cup** and remind yourself that care applies to you too.*

Leo (23 July – 22 August)

Your pink

fuchsia · raspberry · salmon

A pink that **lets you shine without apology**.

Leo is a fire sign ruled by the Sun. Pink suits it as a colour of joy that does not intend to ask permission. Fuchsia and raspberry are like **a rose that knows it is seen**.

What Leo is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality fixed · ruler Sun

Leo is **generous**, proud and creative. It likes to give, likes to rejoice and needs others to see and appreciate it. It is loyal and has a big heart.

Its strength is **warmth** and the ability to inspire others. The weaker side tends to be sensitivity to criticism and a tendency to want to be the centre of attention.

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What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you want to be yourself and do not feel like making yourself smaller. It fits festive occasions as well as an ordinary Monday.

With Leo the strength is often in creativity and generosity. A rich pink can add **joy in your own expression**.

Shadow attention as the measure of worth

In the shadow, Leo measures how visible it is and feels accordingly. Pink then serves as a spotlight that must not go out.

Leo needs recognition and pink may be the colour that draws glances. When the glances vanish, emptiness arrives, because worth has fused with applause.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **choose a pink that pleases you**, even if nobody will judge it.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add gold or deep blue.

gold · dark blue · black

Gold and dark blue give pink maturity and calm.

Leo as ascendant

When Leo is your ascendant, you come across as self-assured, warm and striking. You enter a room in a way that people notice you even when you do not want them to.

Pink gives you warmth and wit. Stronger shades suit you more than powder ones.

In everyday life

Put on something pink today that you do not choose as a gift for others.

*When you feel you must shine, take **a small pink thing that shines only for you**.*

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Virgo (23 August – 22 September)

Your pink

old rose · powder pink · earthy

Pink as **quiet refinement and purity**.

Virgo is an earth sign linked with Mercury, order and care for detail. Pink suits it in muted and clean forms. **Old rose on a linen shirt** or powder on paper.

What Virgo is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Virgo is **meticulous**, attentive and practical. It notices details that others overlook and likes to be useful. It tends to be modest and judges itself more strictly than others.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to improve things. The weaker side tends to be perfectionism, worries and a tendency to criticise itself.

What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you want to soften a strict regime. It fits a work desk, a diary and a wardrobe.

With Virgo the strength is often in attention and order. Old rose can add **a little forgiveness**.

Shadow criticism of your own gentleness

In the shadow, Virgo judges whether it may allow itself pink. Pink is then not joy but a test to be passed.

Virgo likes to do things correctly, so pink things seem too impractical. There is then neither time nor place for its own tenderness.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **take one impractical pink thing** and not apologise.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mercury grey and green.

grey · green · white

Grey and green add order and calm.

Virgo as ascendant

When Virgo is your ascendant, you come across as neat, restrained and reliable. People see you as observant and sensible, sometimes even overly reserved.

Pink gives you a gentle and careful impression. Old rose and powder suit better than a sharp one.

In everyday life

Put a pink pen or mug on your desk and do not correct anything about it.

*When you feel strict, try to **leave one thing imperfect** and look at it through pink.*

Libra (23 September – 22 October)

Your pink

powder pink · pink · old rose

A pink that **suits you in gentleness and style**.

Libra is an air sign ruled by Venus. Pink is its colour naturally, because Venus is also the goddess of beauty. Powder and rose may feel to you like **home in colour**.

What Libra is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality cardinal · ruler Venus

Libra longs for **harmony**, beauty and justice. It is diplomatic, sociable and has a feel for aesthetics. It lives best in relationships in which it does not feel alone.

Its strength is **tact** and the ability to see both sides. The weaker side tends to be hesitation and a tendency to avoid conflict even when it would help.

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What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you want beauty, balance and relationship. It fits a flat, flowers and clothing.

With Libra the strength is often in taste and diplomacy. Pink can add **permission to have your own opinion in a gentle tone**.

Shadow rose-tinted glasses instead of a decision

In the shadow, Libra sees the world as better than it is so that it does not have to deal with anything. Pink then serves as a filter.

Libra seeks harmony and pink may be for it a colour in which one cannot argue. That can delay a necessary change.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **ask what you would say if nobody contradicted you**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Venus green and white.

green · white · ochre

Green and white add calm and reality.

Libra as ascendant

When Libra is your ascendant, you come across as elegant, pleasant and balanced. People like you for your tact, even if inside you take a long time to decide.

Pink gives you a pleasant and balanced impression. Old rose suits your manner best.

In everyday life

Try a pink scarf or peonies on the table and notice what you like and what merely does not bother you.

*When everything seems too sweet, take **one thing in a darker pink** that has its own voice.*

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Scorpio (23 October – 21 November)

Your pink

raspberry · fuchsia · earthy

A pink that **allows you tenderness as a secret**.

Scorpio is a water sign linked with Mars and Pluto, depth and transformation. Pink is unexpected for it, like a gentle touch after a long silence. Raspberry and earthy pink may be closer to you than powder.

What Scorpio is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality fixed · ruler Mars, in the newer view also Pluto

Scorpio is **intense**, deep and loyal. It feels strongly, but does not always show it. It dislikes superficiality and likes to get to what is hidden.

Its strength is **determination** and the ability to transform. The weaker side tends to be distrust, jealousy and a need to keep things under control.

What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you want to be close, but in your own way. It suits a private detail.

With Scorpio the strength is often in depth and loyalty. A richer pink can add **permission to soften**.

Shadow tenderness under lock

In the shadow, Scorpio hides softness because it fears someone might hurt it. Pink then stays in a drawer.

After being hurt, Scorpios open up with difficulty. A colour that is too pretty and public could give away vulnerability. It protects itself, but touch is missing.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **wear pink as a hidden layer**, for example in underwear or a lining.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add black or dark wine.

black · wine · brown

Black and wine give pink protection and mystery.

Scorpio as ascendant

When Scorpio is your ascendant, you come across as focused, mysterious and strong. People sense the intensity of your gaze and often feel that you know more than you say.

Pink gives you an unexpected gentleness behind a mysterious impression. Raspberry is the closest.

In everyday life

Try having pink just for yourself in something nobody sees.

*When you want to withdraw, put on **pink jewellery under your clothes** and let it be your secret.*

Sagittarius (22 November – 21 December)

Your pink

salmon · fuchsia · powder pink

Pink as **a smile on the road**.

Sagittarius is a fire sign linked with Jupiter, freedom and distances. Pink suits it as a cheerful colour that holds nothing against itself. Salmon and fuchsia as **the colour of a sunset over the sea**.

What Sagittarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter

Sagittarius is **optimistic**, open and free-spirited. It loves travel, new experiences and the search for meaning. It speaks honestly, sometimes a little too directly.

Its strength is **enthusiasm** and faith in a good outcome. The weaker side tends to be impatience with detail and a tendency to promise more than can be managed.

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What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you want to rejoice without a plan. It fits a journey, a celebration and an informal meeting.

With Sagittarius the strength is often in optimism and momentum. Pink can add **joy in closeness**.

Shadow idealisation that overlooks reality

In the shadow, Sagittarius sees pink even when it should see clearly. Optimism turns into denial.

Sagittarians believe everything will turn out well and pink confirms it for them. This way one can unintentionally overlook what harms in the long run.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **put on rose-tinted glasses only for a moment** and then look without them.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Jupiter blue or gold.

blue gold green

Blue and gold give pink reach and reality.

Sagittarius as ascendant

When Sagittarius is your ascendant, you come across as open, jovial and adventurous. People see you as someone with a wide outlook and an appetite for discovery.

Pink gives you a light and friendly impression. Stronger shades suit you more than pale ones.

In everyday life

Take a pink scarf or mug on the road. When you look back, sit for a while and look at a photograph.

*When something seems too good, try to **look at it with a friend who tells the truth**.*

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Capricorn (22 December – 19 January)

Your pink

old rose · earthy · raspberry

A pink that **lets you be serious and gentle**.

Capricorn is an earth sign linked with Saturn, responsibility and perseverance. Pink does not seem to fit it at first glance, but muted old rose or raspberry adds **a maturity that can warm**.

What Capricorn is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality cardinal · ruler Saturn

Capricorn is **responsible**, goal-oriented and disciplined. It likes to build and is not afraid of a long road. It has a dry sense of humour and shows it only to those it trusts.

Its strength is **perseverance** and the ability to see things through. The weaker side tends to be strictness with itself, reserve and a tendency to put joy off until later.

What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you want to soften performance. It fits a detail in clothing, in the office and at home.

With Capricorn the strength is often in order and perseverance. Old rose can add **a willingness to rest**.

Shadow fear that gentleness will topple authority

In the shadow, Capricorn rejects softness because it might look unserious in it. Authority turns into hardness.

Capricorn fears that if it showed tenderness it would not be taken seriously. So it dresses in dark and grey and gentleness stays at home.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **start with one pink thing that is professional**, for example in shape or material.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Saturn grey and brown.

graphite · brown · black

Grey and brown give pink weight and stability.

Capricorn as ascendant

When Capricorn is your ascendant, you come across as serious, mature and reserved. People may see you as older than you are, and only later discover how funny you are.

Pink gives you an unobtrusive touch of softness. Old rose works best.

In everyday life

Put a pink lining or button on serious clothing.

*When you are too strict, try to **look at a pink thing and not improve anything**.*

Aquarius (20 January – 18 February)

Your pink

fuchsia · sky blue · powder pink

Pink as **an unexpected idea** among colours.

Aquarius is an air sign linked with Saturn and Uranus, independence and ideas. Pink belongs to it as an unconventional choice. Fuchsia next to light blue looks like **the colour of the future**.

What Aquarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality fixed · ruler Saturn, in the newer view also Uranus

Aquarius is **independent**, original and idealistic. It is interested in ideas, humanity and the future. It wants to go its own way and does not like adapting to expectations.

Its strength is **perspective** and the ability to come up with new things. The weaker side tends to be distance from feelings and a tendency to withdraw when there is too much closeness.

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What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you want to do something unusual, but with lightness. It fits a poster, a logo and clothing.

With Aquarius the strength is often in originality and perspective. Pink can add **kindness without lecturing**.

Shadow irony towards everything soft

In the shadow, Aquarius jokes about sweetness so that it does not have to touch its own tenderness. Pink is then a joke, not a feeling.

Aquarians like to keep a detached view and pink seems too sentimental to them. So they use it ironically and stay silent about the real feeling.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **say aloud what you really like about pink** and add nothing to it.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add a cool blue or silver.

sky blue · silver · white

Blue and silver give pink clarity and distance.

Aquarius as ascendant

When Aquarius is your ascendant, you come across as independent, a little unusual and friendly. People see you as an original personality who keeps their own space.

Pink gives you an unexpected and friendly impression. Striking shades are the closest.

In everyday life

Try putting one pink thing in your bag for a week and not explaining it.

*When something seems sweet to you, try to **tell yourself what you like about it**.*

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Pisces (19 February – 20 March)

Your pink

powder pink · old rose · lilac

Pink as **a dream of a good world**.

Pisces is a water sign linked with Jupiter and Neptune, feeling and imagination. Pink is its colour naturally, like a blurred watercolour trace. **Powder and lilac** may remind you of dawn over water.

What Pisces is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter, in the newer view also Neptune

Pisces is **empathic**, intuitive and dreamy. It picks up the moods around it and often has a rich imagination. It frequently has a bond with art, music and spirituality.

Its strength is **compassion** and creative fantasy. The weaker side tends to be merging with other people's feelings, escaping into dreams and difficulty setting boundaries.

What it can support in you

Pink can support moments when you want to dream and feel softness. It fits a bedroom, a picture and a scent.

With Pisces the strength is often in empathy and imagination. Pink can add **a willingness to be kind to yourself too**.

Shadow escape into a sweet dream

In the shadow, Pisces flees into a pink world where nothing is heavy. The dream becomes a place into which nothing real can be brought.

Pisces are sensitive and pink gives them support in the beautiful. But only the beautiful does not cover every day. Reality can then be all the sharper.

The colour can help you here too. It helps to **add something solid to pink**, for example wood or a linen tablecloth.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add brown or dark green.

brown · bottle green · grey

Brown and green give pink soil and weight.

Pisces as ascendant

When Pisces is your ascendant, you come across as gentle, dreamy and adaptable. People like to project their wishes onto you and tend to be kind to you.

Pink gives you a soft and dreamy impression. Powder and lilac are the closest.

In everyday life

In the evening light a candle, take a pink thing and write three sentences about your day.

*When you feel like running away, take **a pink thing firmly in your hand** and return to the room.*

FOR A DEEPER LOOK

Seasons

Pink is the colour of spring and late summer. Blossoming apple and cherry trees, then peonies and roses. Autumn adds old-rose and heather tones. Ask yourself when you reach for it.

Time of day

Dawn and dusk are the moments when the sky turns pink. Morning brings lightness, evening stillness. Midday tends to be too sharp for pink.

Years of life

Saturn orbits the Sun in roughly 29 years. Astrology speaks of its returns at about 29 and 58 and reads them as times when a person asks what is truly their own. Pink may feel close to you in those years as a reminder of softness, or on the contrary foreign, like a farewell to the role of the good girl. Both are natural. Research by Palmer and Schloss (2010) also reports that we like colours according to the things and experiences we link with them. Astrology does not rule that out, it merely offers another view.

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Colour for your website and business

Yes – but more as a gentle accent than as the only voice.

In business, pink is a colour that **invites closeness**, but at the same time carries a label of sweetness. It can look caring, playful, fashionable and very striking. That is why it is good to know what you are promising before you let it into your logo, website or advert.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help create a **distinctive impression**, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Pink can say, for example

"I am here for you." "You can relax." "It's personal." "It's playful."

- **Tenderness and care.** Muted pink invites a slower pace and the feeling of being looked after.
- **Playfulness.** It is linked with lightness, sweets and celebration.
- **Femininity and fashion.** Today people link it with women, but that is not a law, so handle it without clichés.
- **Courage.** A sharp fuchsia says you do not want to hide.
- **Sweetness.** It can be good, but also too much. Take care that it does not oversweeten a serious offer.

Depending on the shade it also feels different. Powder and peach are **soft and personal**, old rose **nostalgic and calm**, raspberry and fuchsia **striking and self-assured**.

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Simple tips

As an accent, not a wall

It suits a logo, a button or a detail. Keep large areas light and calm.

Shade by role

Powder for care, old rose for story, fuchsia for courage.

Combinations

With wood and cream for softness, with black and white for a graphic look.

Cultural context

In Thailand it is the colour of Tuesday, in India it means the strength of women, in Europe it carries a children's label. Before you go out into the world, find out what pink means at home and where you are heading.

Legibility

Light pink text on white is almost unreadable. Use a darker shade or dark text.

Colour blindness

About 1 in 12 men has trouble telling red and green apart. Do not use these two colours as the only difference between two things.

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Professions where it is a Yes

The rule is simple. When you sell care, playfulness or the courage to be seen, pink can help you.

Care, cosmetics, massage and personal services

Muted pink can accompany a personal and gentle presentation, especially when it matches the real setting, materials and way of working. If you want to reach different people, do not derive the whole design from the idea that **care must be pink and aimed only at women**.

Flowers, confectionery and weddings

Pink can follow a real flower, icing or festive decoration. Make sure it lets the product stand out. When the website, background, packaging and photographs are all pink, **the cake may blend into its surroundings**.

Fashion, culture and original work

A rich pink can be a striking mark of recognition on a poster, on packaging or as the main motif. It does not have to be cute. With simple lettering and dark contrast it feels **direct and self-assured**.

Toys, stationery and gifts

Pink belongs with the joy of a gift and a small celebration. Try it with honest materials and clean lettering so that it does not look like one more plastic toy.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Crisis help and accompaniment through a hard period.** An over-sweet tone can feel as though the seriousness of the experience were lost under decoration.
- **Professional and technical services.** Pink is not forbidden, but the offer must be concrete and clear. The colour alone neither guarantees nor refutes expertise.
- **Long texts and important information.** Light pink lettering on white is often hard to read.
- **Presenting food, skin or pictures.** A pink filter can distort real shades.

Try a striking shade in waiting rooms and rest areas first in a smaller amount.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer and ask "What would you expect from such a place or service?" **Is the offer visible, or mainly the pink?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that pink means tenderness.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know pink from toys, from cafés and from the street. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Barbie (toys)**
  The Barbie doll was introduced by Mattel at the New York toy fair on 9 March 1959. Pink became so firmly tied to her that after the 2023 film people speak of the "barbiecore" style. The colour became the hallmark of a world that is not afraid to be loud.

- **T-Mobile (telecommunications)**
  Deutsche Telekom and its subsidiary brand T-Mobile use magenta as the corporate colour. According to an article in Ad Age from November 2019, T-Mobile claimed exclusive rights to this colour and defended it against similar brands.

- **Dunkin’ (coffee and doughnuts)**
  The chain was founded in 1950 in Quincy, Massachusetts, by Bill Rosenberg. It began using pink in 1966 and added orange in 1980. In 2018 and 2019 it shortened its name to Dunkin’. Pink and orange is today a loud and friendly signature.

- **Lyft (ride-sharing)**
  The service began in 2012 as Zimride and was renamed Lyft in May 2013. Drivers wore big pink fluffy moustaches on their cars. In January 2015 a small glowing moustache for the dashboard arrived. Pink made a stranger's car a friendly ride.

What they have in common is that pink carries a simple message. **Close, playful, loud.** And it is mostly not everywhere, only where it should stand out.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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Different colour combinations

Pink + red

How it feels

From one family. Pink is a lightened red, so together they look like two sisters. Red gives pink strength and pink gives red a little smile.

When it suits

When you want **strength with softness**.

Specific shades



pink + red
playfully



raspberry + burgundy
deeply



powder + coral
gently



fuchsia + scarlet
boldly



old rose + brick
earthily

In practice

Lipstick and a pink scarf. Pink bedding with a red accent.

Watch out

Two related colours can merge. Give one of them **more space**.

Pink + orange

How it feels

Peach and sunset. Pink and orange are warm neighbours that together look like a cocktail or a summer evening.

When it suits

When you want **playfulness and warmth**.

Specific shades



pink + orange
radiantly



raspberry + terracotta
richly



powder + apricot
softly



fuchsia + pumpkin
daringly



old rose + rust
earthily

In practice

An apricot throw with a pink cushion. Pink and orange on a poster.

Watch out

An over-sweet cocktail. Try to **mute one of the colours with something earthier**.

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Pink + yellow

How it feels

Flower and sun. Yellow lights pink up and pink gives yellow softness.

When it suits

When you want **cheerful lightness**.

Specific shades


pink + yellow
cheerfully


raspberry + ochre
golden


powder + butter
springlike


fuchsia + lemon
radiantly


old rose + mustard
kindly

In practice

A yellow laid table with a pink flower. Powder and butter in a children's book.

Watch out

At equal saturation the colours pull against each other. Keep one of them **lighter**.

Pink + green

How it feels

Blossom among leaves. Green and pink are a natural pair. A peony and its leaves, an apple tree in bloom.

When it suits

When you want **natural contrast**.

Specific shades


pink + green
naturally


raspberry + bottle green
gardenlike


powder + mint
freshly


fuchsia + emerald
boldly


old rose + sage
quietly

In practice

Peonies in a vase and bottle-green ceramics. A green plant and an old-rose cushion.

Watch out

A sharp fuchsia next to a rich green sounds loud. **Mute** the green.

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Pink + blue

How it feels

Dawn over water. Blue cools pink and pink softens blue.

When it suits

When you want **calm with tenderness**.

Specific shades



pink + blue
calmly



raspberry + dark blue
deeply



powder + sky
airily



fuchsia + cobalt
freshly



old rose + denim
soberly

In practice

A blue jumper and a powder scarf. Sky-blue and powder bedding.

Watch out

Both are cooler. Without warmth the whole can feel **cold**.

Pink + indigo

How it feels

Depth and softness. Indigo gives pink seriousness and pink gives indigo light. Together they recall an evening sky.

When it suits

When you want **depth without heaviness**.

Specific shades



pink + indigo
at dusk



raspberry + ink
deeply



powder + twilight blue
softly



fuchsia + ultramarine
dramatically



old rose + grey-indigo
soberly

In practice

An indigo coat and an old-rose scarf. A navy wall and a pink picture.

Watch out

Dark and light together must be in balanced proportion. Keep indigo **in the background**.

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Pink + violet

How it feels

Neighbours from the rainbow. Pink and purple are related. Purple deepens pink and pink softens purple.

When it suits

When you want **sensuality and depth**.

Specific shades


pink + purple
playfully


raspberry + plum
sensually


powder + lavender
tenderly


fuchsia + orchid
richly


old rose + grey-violet
dustily

In practice

Lilac and powder on cushions. Plum and raspberry in jewellery.

Watch out

An over-sugary whole feels sweet. Add **a neutral colour**.

Pink + grey

How it feels

Elegant calm. Grey mutes pink and makes it urban. Together they look tasteful and sober.

When it suits

When you want **elegance without sweetness**.

Specific shades


pink + grey
soberly


raspberry + graphite
elegantly


powder + silver
lightly


fuchsia + slate
modernly


old rose + dove
quietly

In practice

A grey coat and a pink scarf. A grey wall and an old-rose throw.

Watch out

A cold grey with a sharp pink is **unforgiving**. Try a warmer material.

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Pink + brown

How it feels

Ground underfoot. Brown grounds pink and mutes it. Together they recall porcelain on wood or a peony on clay.

When it suits

When you want **earthiness with softness**.

Specific shades



pink + brown
earthily



raspberry + chocolate
deeply



powder + beige
softly



fuchsia + caramel
autumnally



old rose + linen
naturally

In practice

A wooden table and a powder cushion. Brown leather and old rose.

Watch out

A large brown area can **silence** pink. Leave it some light.

Pink + white

How it feels

A clean sheet. White brightens pink and gives it space. Together they feel fresh, like a peony in a white vase.

When it suits

When you want **purity and lightness**.

Specific shades



pink + white
cleanly



raspberry + ivory
elegantly



powder + snow
freshly



fuchsia + milk
strikingly



old rose + bone
gently

In practice

A white kitchen with pink ceramics. A white shirt and a pink scarf.

Watch out

Too much white can feel **clinical**. Add wood or linen.

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Pink + black

How it feels

Graphic contrast. Black makes pink a bold colour. Together they look modern and a little rebellious.

When it suits

When you want **expression and courage**.

Specific shades


pink + black
modernly


raspberry + charcoal
dramatically


powder + anthracite
soberly


fuchsia + ink black
provocatively


old rose + soot
discreetly

In practice

A black jacket and a pink shirt. A blackboard and pink chalk.

Watch out

Two strong colours tend to be loud. Add **white**.

Pink + gold

How it feels

A festive detail. Gold highlights pink and gives it shine. Together they look festive and a little retro.

When it suits

When you want **celebration without heaviness**.

Specific shades


pink + gold
festively


raspberry + antique gold
richly


powder + champagne
gently


fuchsia + rich gold
radiantly


old rose + matte gold
subduedly

In practice

Gold jewellery on a powder jumper. Pink packaging with gold lettering.

Watch out

In excess gold drowns out ordinary comfort and the space recalls **a shop window**.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **soften** pink, add **white**, **cream**, **linen** or **wood**.
- When you want to **ground** it, add **brown**, **green** or **ochre**.
- When you want to **deepen** it, **raspberry**, **indigo** or **dark blue** will help.
- When you want to **emphasise** it, add **black**, **gold** or **red**.

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